NOVA SCHOOL OF SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Interação Pessoa-Máquina

Assignment 1





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Introduction

For this assignment, I decided to use the Epic Games Launcher to find some bad interface examples, and Steam to find some good interface examples.

Both are (mainly) videogame store platforms, where a user can buy videogames, manage their library, add friends, and more.

Since they both have the same goal, they will have some similarities, therefore finding good and bad interface aspects is easier through the comparison of these two platforms.





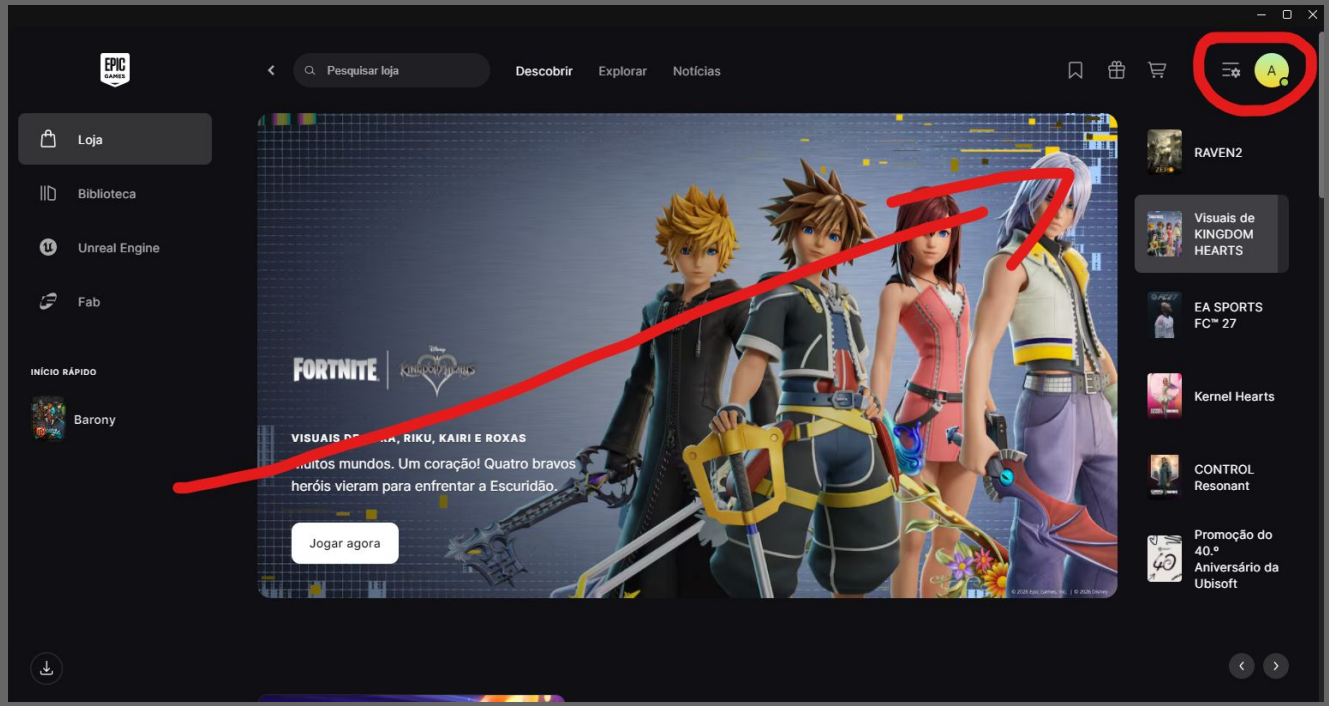
Bad Interface: In Epic Games Launcher



1. Changing tabs also changes button positions and design (Settings, Profile)

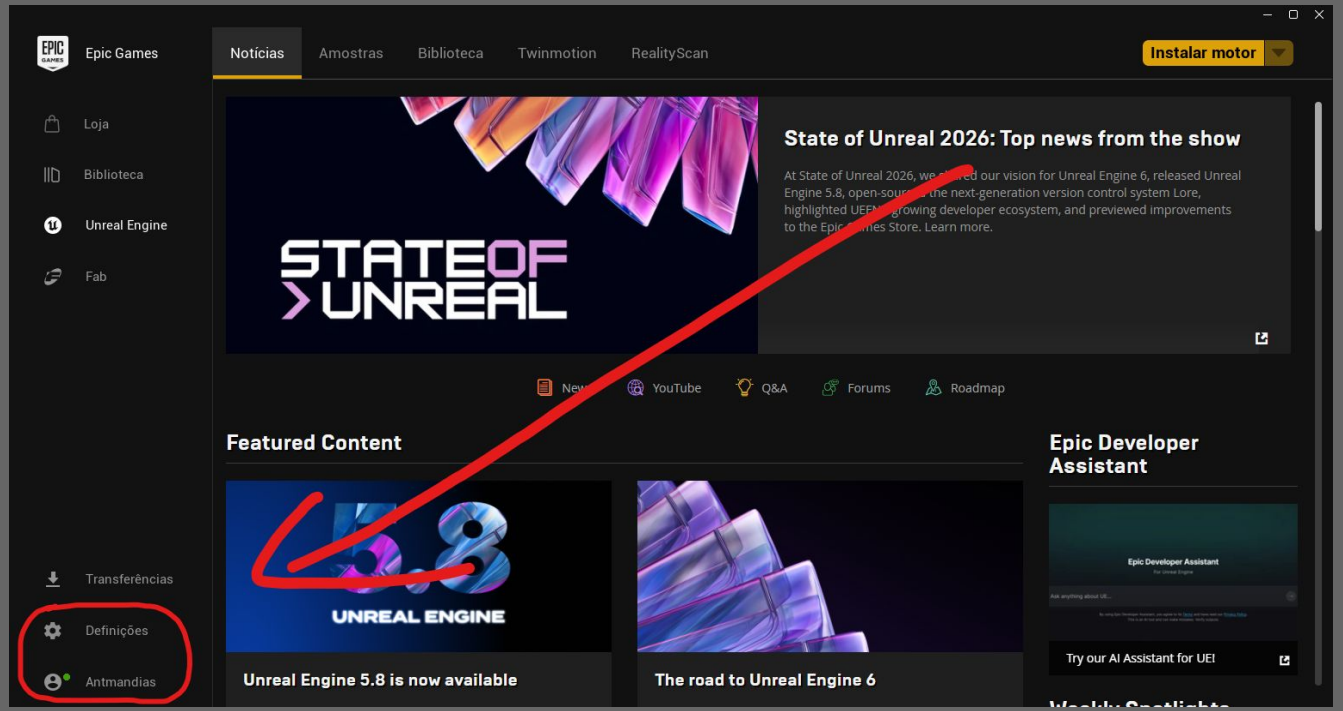
In Epic Games, there are multiple tabs that completely change important buttons' (such as settings and profile) positions, which shows bad consistency across the application.

Store Tab (Buttons in top right corner)



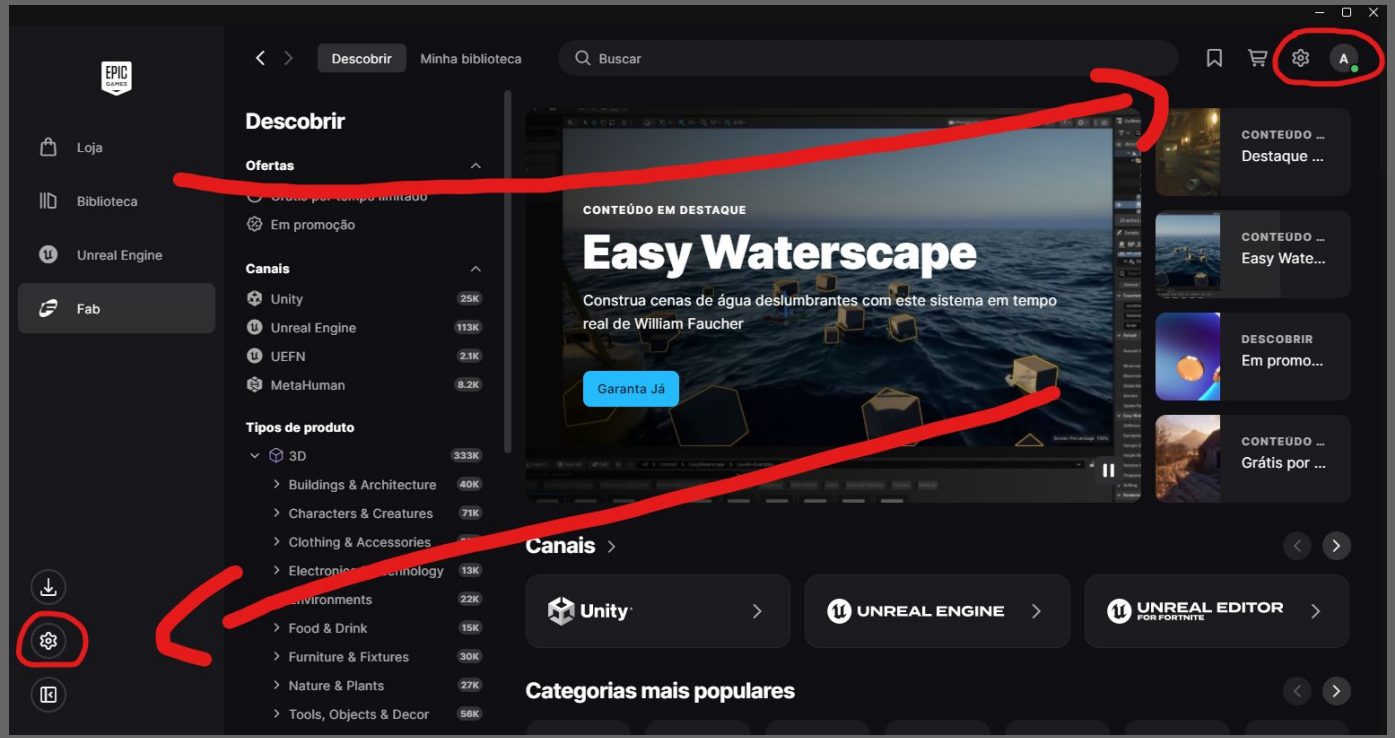
1. Changing tabs also changes button positions and design (Settings, Profile)

Unreal Engine Tab (Buttons in bottom left corner)



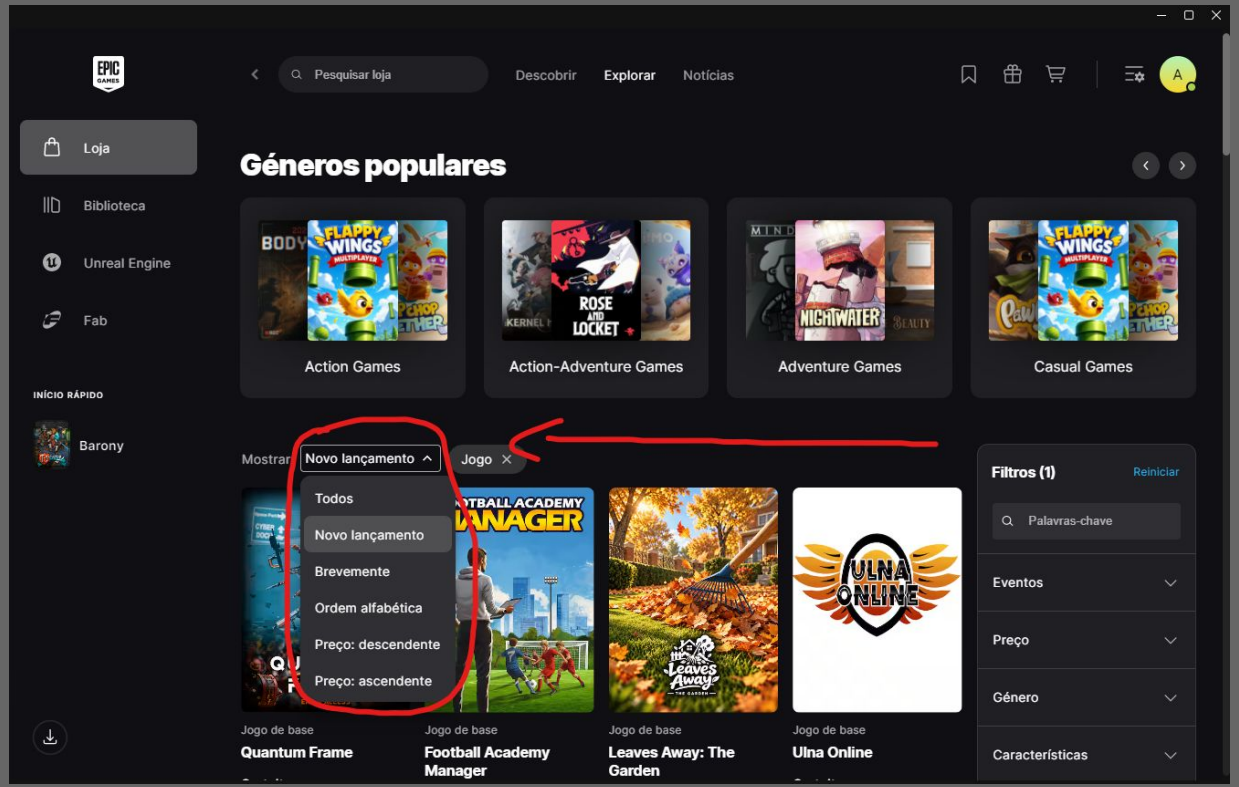
1. Changing tabs also changes button positions and design (Settings, Profile)

Fab Tab (Buttons in bottom left AND top right corner)



2. Store Explore Screen

Epic Games' explore screen, meant for discovering new games, has very limited discoverability.
The default list filter only shows the most recent games released on the platform, which usually only shows quickly made, small games that are irrelevant for the average user. The filters that a user can apply regarding game genres can be generic or unclear, such as "Action", "Action-Adventure", "Adventure"...



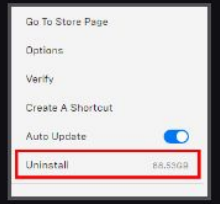
3. Moving game installation folder

Epic Games Launcher's interface has no integrated support for moving a game's installation folder, leading official support instructions for this matter to be unnecessarily complex and hard to understand.

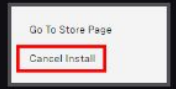
How to move an installed game from the Epic Games Launcher to another directory on your computer

If you have a game installed on your computer from the Epic Games Launcher you can move it to another location using these steps:

1. Make a backup copy the game you want to move on your computer.
    a. Navigate to the game installation directory. (Default: **C:Program FilesEpic Games[Game Name]**)
    b. Copy this game folder to another location on your computer.
2. Open the Epic Games Launcher.
3. Click on **Library**.
4. Locate the game you want to move. Click on the three dots next to it and click on **Uninstall**.



5. Once the game is uninstalled, click on the game in your **Library** to start installing it and select the new installation location you would like it to be in.
6. Once the download begins, after 2-3% is downloaded click on the three dots next to the game name and click on **Cancel Install**.



7. Navigate to the new installation directory you selected for the game and copy the backed up game folder to this location. If you receive a warning to replace any duplicate files click on **Replace** to do so.
8. Resume the installation process.
9. Once the files are verified, you should be able to launch the game.

Good Interface: In Steam

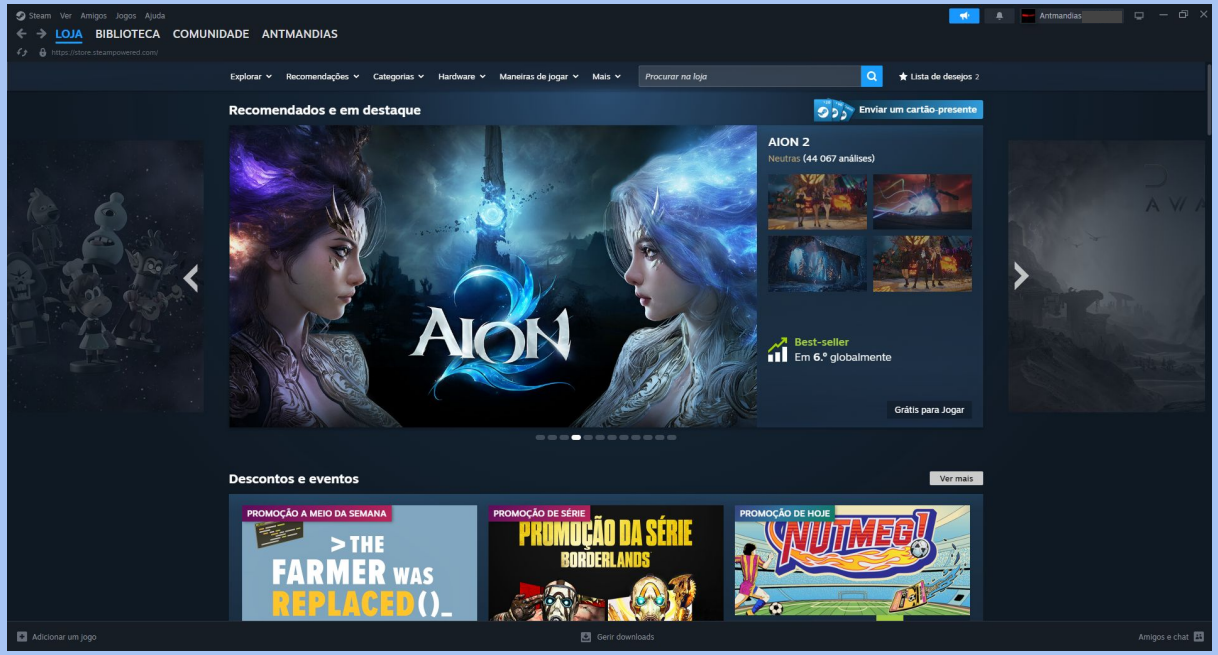


1. Consistent Design

The top and bottom main UI elements remain consistent in every tab.

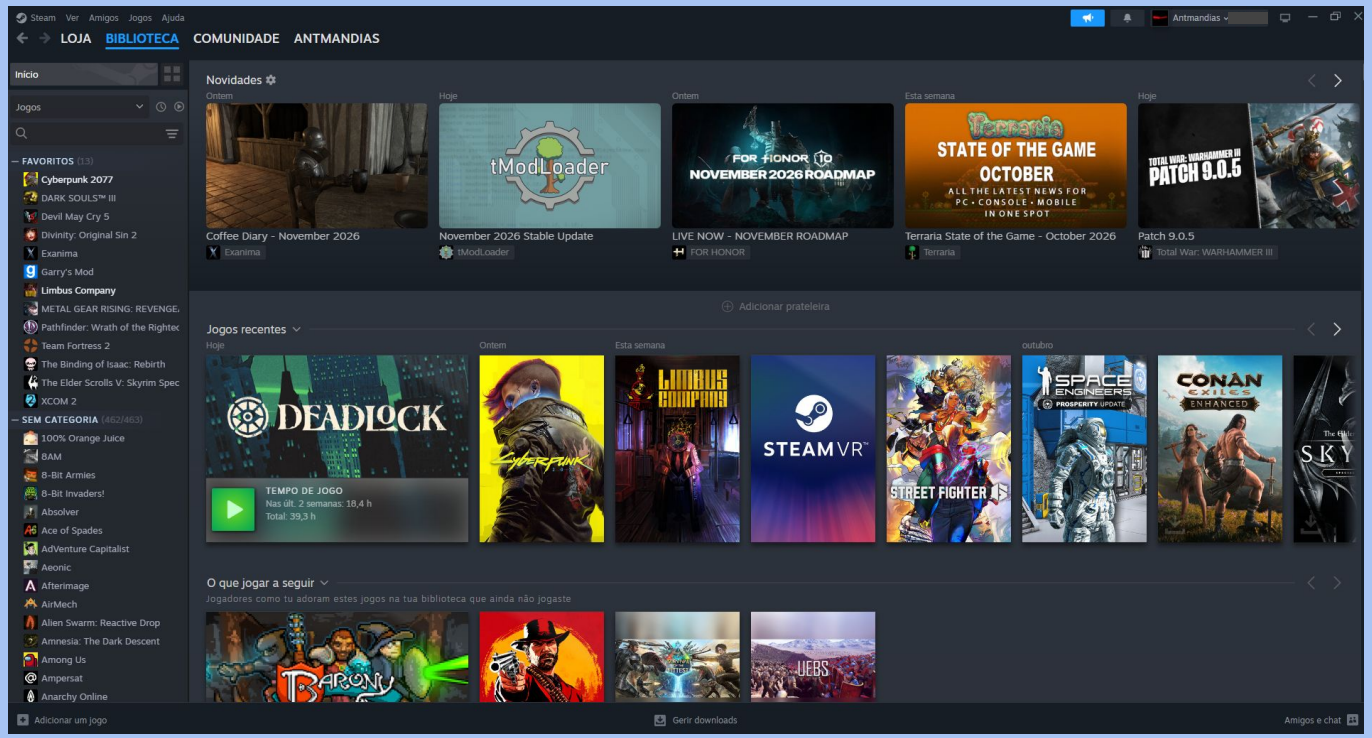
The current tab is also clearly highlighted, allowing the user to easily know the state of the application. The user can also see a lot of buttons leading to possible actions in this consistent design, with drop-down menus to present more specific options (such as “Start” or “Collections” in library, both discoverable by just pressing “Library”), which shows good discoverability.

Store Tab



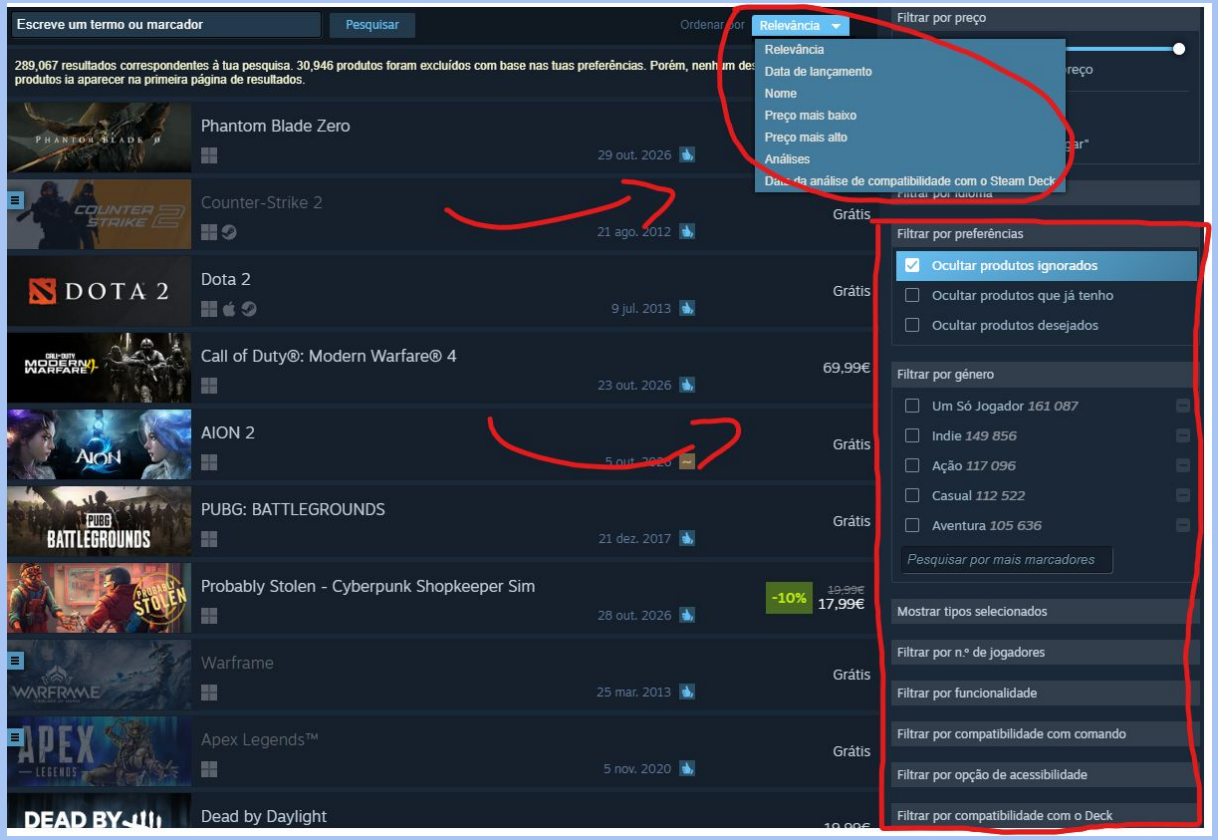
1. Consistent Design

Library Tab



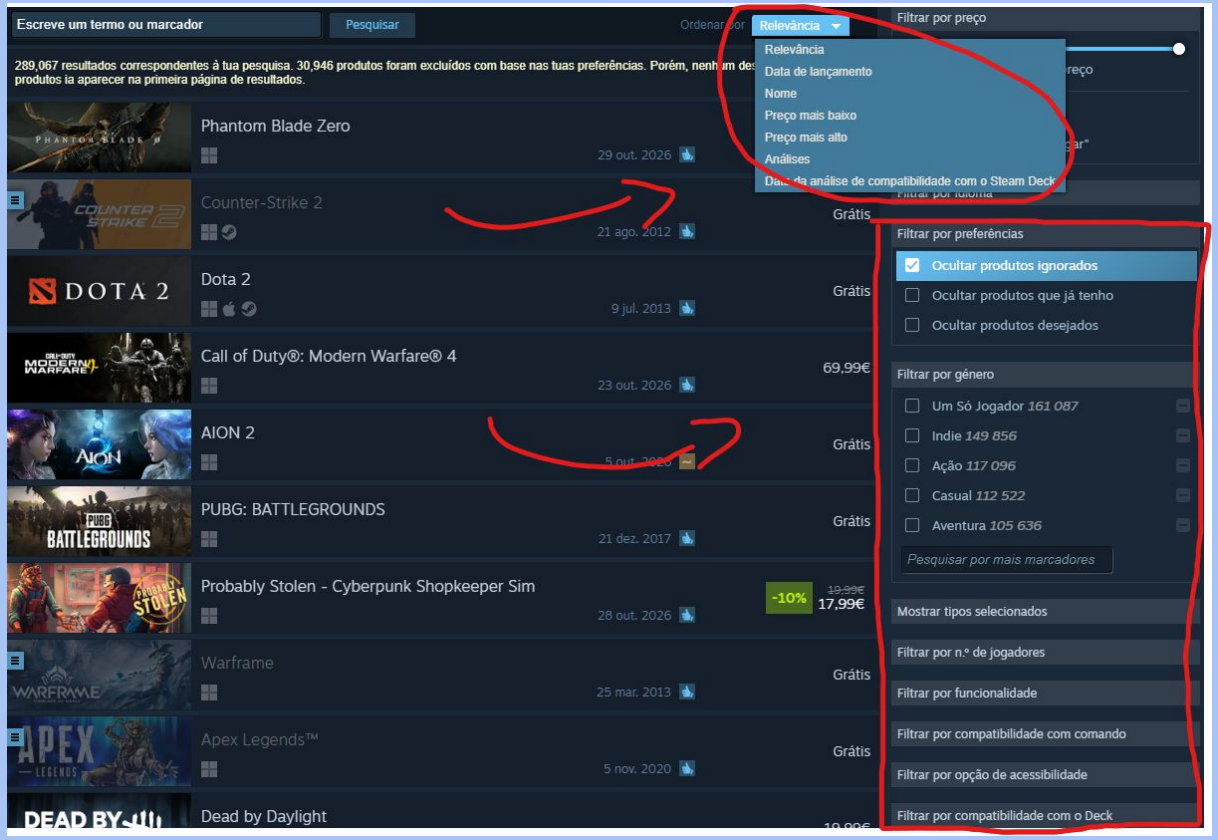
2. Store Explore Screen

Steam's game discovery screen shows great discoverability, by default sorted by "Relevance" (depends on popularity and how recent they are) which naturally appeals to the average user, and many filter options to facilitate finding specific games.



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3. Moving game installation folder

The Steam settings page allows a user to change a game’s installation folder entirely within the interface. Official Steam support shows a simple example, the user just needs to select what games have to be moved, what folder they are going, and press the “Move” button.

